CROCHET PATTERN

Pastel Rainbow Cloud Ornament

A crochet rainbow arch and puffy cloud on a beaded cord with a rainbow tassel



SKILL LEVEL	FINISHED SIZE	YARN	HOOK
Intermediate	≈ 20 cm (7.9 in) plus an 8 cm loop	DK cotton · 7 colours	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)

A five-colour rainbow arch worked in one piece in rows, set into a lightly stuffed cloud made from two joined pieces, hanging above a striped rainbow tassel.

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MATERIALS · GAUGE · ABBREVIATIONS

Before You Begin

Materials & Tools

Yarn A (pink)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn B (peach)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn C (yellow)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn D (mint)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn E (blue)	DK (#3) cotton — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn F (cloud, cord, tassel neck)	DK (#3) cotton, cream — approx. 9 m (9 yd), about 4 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Yarn G (tassel only)	DK (#3) cotton, lilac — approx. 3 m (4 yd), about 2 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Hook	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)
Beads	1 gold-tone beads 6 mm (hole at least 2.5 mm); 2 natural wooden beads 12 mm (hole at least 3 mm). Both cord strands must pass through each bead together — test before you start.
Notions	fiberfill (a little), tapestry needle, stiff card for the tassel, pins, scissors

Gauge

GAUGE 22 sc and 24 rows/rnds = 10 cm (4 in) in single crochet with a 2.5 mm hook. Gauge is not critical for an ornament, but work firmly so that stuffing does not show and flat pieces keep their shape; sizes depend on your tension.

How to swatch: Optional density check: ch 12, then work 10 rows of sc on 11 sts. The square should measure about 5 cm (2 in) wide and 4 cm (1.6 in) tall. If it is larger or you see gaps between stitches, use a smaller hook.

Finished Measurements

Part	Width	Height
Rainbow arch	≈ 5.3 cm (2.1 in)	≈ 4.7 cm (1.9 in)
Cloud (lightly stuffed)	≈ 6.7 cm (2.6 in)	≈ 3.4 cm (1.3 in)
Tassel	–	10 cm (4 in)

CHOOSING A SIZE One size. For a larger ornament use light worsted (#4) cotton and a 3 mm hook; for a smaller one use sport-weight cotton and a 2 mm hook. Beads and tassel length can be changed freely.

Abbreviations (US terms)

ch	chain	**dc**	double crochet
sc	single crochet	**st(s)**	stitch(es)
inc	2 sc in the same stitch	**rnd(s)**	round(s)
sl st	slip stitch	**( ) xN**	work the sequence in brackets N times

Pattern Notes

- Terms: US crochet terms are used throughout; UK makers: US sc is the UK double crochet.
- Stitch counts: the number in parentheses at the end of a row or round is the number of stitches you have when it is finished. Tick the box when you finish each step.
- Spiral rounds (magic-ring pieces with no "Join"): do not join or turn; mark the first stitch of each round and move the marker up.
- Joined rounds (the round says "Join"): unless the round says otherwise, start with ch 1 (does not count as a stitch) and finish with a sl st into the first stitch.
- Rows: ch 1 at the end of a row, before turning, does not count as a stitch.
- Right side: for pieces in rounds, the outside of the rounds; for pieces in rows, choose the neater side and mark it. "Wrong sides together" means the marked right sides face out.
- Tails: leave a 20 cm (8 in) tail on pieces that will be sewn; weave in all other ends as you go.

Techniques

Colour change — Work the last stitch in the old colour until 2 loops remain on the hook, complete it with the new colour. Cut the old colour leaving a 10 cm tail and weave it in on the wrong side.

Joining two pieces with sc — Hold the pieces wrong sides together with the edges matching. Insert the hook through the stitch or row-end of BOTH pieces at once and work the sc as usual, so one round of sc joins and edges them.

Tassel neck wrap — Lay a 5 cm loop of the wrapping strand along the tassel, pointing down. Wrap the long end tightly around tassel and loop, from the top down. Pass the end through the loop, then pull the short tail at the top until the loop disappears under the wraps. Trim both ends and hide them in the skirt.

Order of Work

- Read Before You Begin and gather the beads; check that both cord strands pass through every bead.
- Crochet: Rainbow Arch.
- Crochet: Cloud.
- Make the tassel and tie the hanging cord into it (Tassel).
- String beads and pieces on the cord, tie the knot and the hanging loop (Assembly & Finishing).

YARNS E, D, C, B, A · MAKE 1

Rainbow Arch

The arch is worked in one piece in rows, starting with the inner (blue) arc. Each row adds 3 sts in the middle while the first and last 5–6 sts stay straight, so the strip curves into an arch with straight legs. Change colour at the end of every row.

☐	**Row 1**	With Yarn E (blue), ch 16. Sc in 2nd ch from hook and in each ch across. Change to Yarn D (mint) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(15)**
☐	**Row 2**	sc 5, (inc, sc 1) x2, inc, sc 5. Change to Yarn C (yellow) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(18)**
☐	**Row 3**	sc 5, inc, sc 3, inc, sc 2, inc, sc 5. Change to Yarn B (peach) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(21)**
☐	**Row 4**	sc 6, (inc, sc 3) x2, inc, sc 6. Change to Yarn A (pink) in the last st; ch 1, turn.	**(24)**
☐	**Row 5**	sc 6, inc, sc 5, inc, sc 4, inc, sc 6. Fasten off.	**(27)**

TIP Weave the colour tails into the row they belong to on the back. Pin the arch into an even semicircle and steam it lightly before joining it to the cloud.

YARN F (CREAM) · MAKE 2 PIECES, THEN JOIN

Cloud

Cloud piece (make 2)

☐	**Row 1**	Foundation: make a chain of 14. Sc in 2nd ch from hook and in each ch across. Ch 1, turn.	**(13)**
☐	**Rows 2–4**	sc 13. Ch 1, turn (3 rows).	**(13)**
☐	**Row 5**	Bumps: sl st in first st, (skip 1 st, 7 dc in next st, skip 1 st, sl st in next st) x3. Fasten off.	**(25)**

Joining round

☐	**Rnd 1**	Hold the two cloud pieces wrong sides together, bumps at the top, and slide the rainbow legs 1.5 cm (0.6 in) down between them, centred. With Yarn F, work through both layers (and through the legs where they sit): 3 sc in the first corner of the foundation edge, sc in each of the next 11 foundation ch, 3 sc in the last corner, sc in each of 4 row-ends up the side, sc in each sl st and dc across the bumps, sc in each of 4 row-ends down the other side.	**(50)**
		Before closing the last 10 sts, stuff the cloud lightly so it stays flat. Join with a sl st to the first sc and fasten off.	

YARNS A–E, G; YARN F FOR NECK AND CORD

Tassel

Make the tassel when the crochet pieces are finished. The hanging cord is tied into its top, so it runs up through the whole ornament and is anchored in the tassel.

☐	**Step 1**	Cut a piece of stiff card 11 cm (4.3 in) tall. Wrap each of Yarns A, B, C, D, E and G around the card 7 times, one colour next to the other in rainbow order (42 wraps). Cut the yarn at the bottom edge.
☐	**Step 2**	Cut the hanging cord: one 100 cm (39 in) length of Yarn F (cream). Slide it under all the wraps along the top edge of the card so that its middle sits there, and tie it in a tight square knot around the wraps. Both cord ends now point upwards.
☐	**Step 3**	Cut through all the wraps along the bottom edge of the card and remove the card. Let the strands hang down from the cord knot.
☐	**Step 4**	Tassel neck: cut a 70 cm length of Yarn F. Measure 2 cm down from the top fold and wrap it tightly 8 times around the bundle (see Tassel neck wrap in Techniques).
☐	**Step 5**	Trim the skirt evenly to 10 cm (3.9 in) from the top fold. Hold it over steam (or dampen it) and comb the strands straight with your fingers; let it dry hanging.

Assembly & Finishing

- Thread both cord ends together through a large-eye tapestry needle (or a bead needle with a big eye). Work upwards from the tassel.
- String, from the tassel upwards: 1 wooden bead → 1 gold bead → the cloud and rainbow → 1 wooden bead.
- Cloud and rainbow: push the needle up through the cloud from the centre of its bottom edge to the top of the middle bump, take the cord up through the opening of the arch and out through the top of the arch at the 14th (centre) st of Row 5.
- Push everything down snugly onto the tassel so there are no gaps. Holding both cord ends together, tie one overhand knot right above the top bead to lock the stack.
- Hanging loop: tie the two cord ends together with a square knot so that the loop measures 8 cm (3 in) from the overhand knot to the top. Trim the ends to 5 mm and add a drop of fabric glue to the knot if you like.

SAFETY This is a decoration, not a toy, and not suitable for children under 3 years. Beads and cords are a choking and strangling hazard: hang it out of reach of babies, young children and pets.

Checkpoints & Troubleshooting

Count your stitches at these points; the numbers match the rows above.

Piece	After	Stitches
Rainbow Arch	Row 1	15
Rainbow Arch	Row 5	27
Cloud piece (make 2)	Row 1	13
Cloud piece (make 2)	Row 5	25
Joining round	Rnd 1	50

- One stitch too many or too few: check the last increase or decrease round, and that you did not work into the slip-stitch join or the ch 1 at the start of a row.
- Piece cups or ripples: your tension differs from the gauge; change hook size by 0.25–0.5 mm rather than the stitch counts.
- Stuffing shows through: use a smaller hook, or stuff a little less firmly.
- Flat pieces curl: pin them out, mist with water (or starch) and let them dry flat.
- Cord will not pass through a bead: thread one strand at a time with a fine needle, or use beads with larger holes.

THANK YOU Thank you for making this ornament. Happy crocheting!